

case studies

You're asking about case studies – likely to understand real-world examples of successful entrepreneurship!

Case studies are incredibly valuable for your MEET entrepreneurship journey! They show you how real founders tackled problem/solution fit, discovered customers, built MVPs, and scaled their businesses. By analyzing case studies, you'll see practical applications of concepts like value propositions, business model pivots, and unfair advantages in action.

Some legendary case studies to explore:

- **Airbnb** (2008) – How they discovered customers weren't renters but hosts, and built a marketplace with strong network effects
- **Slack** (2013) – A tool built as an internal solution that became a billion-dollar company through word-of-mouth
- **Dropbox** (2008) – How they used a simple explainer video to find product-market fit
- **Instagram** (2010) – From a check-in app to a photo-sharing phenomenon by pivoting based on user behavior

Resources to dive deeper:

- Y Combinator's startup library (ycombinator.com/library)
- "Lean Startup" by Eric Ries (case study-rich)
- Podcast: "How I Built This" by NPR

Your concrete action: Pick ONE case study of a company in your industry/space, and write down: What was their original